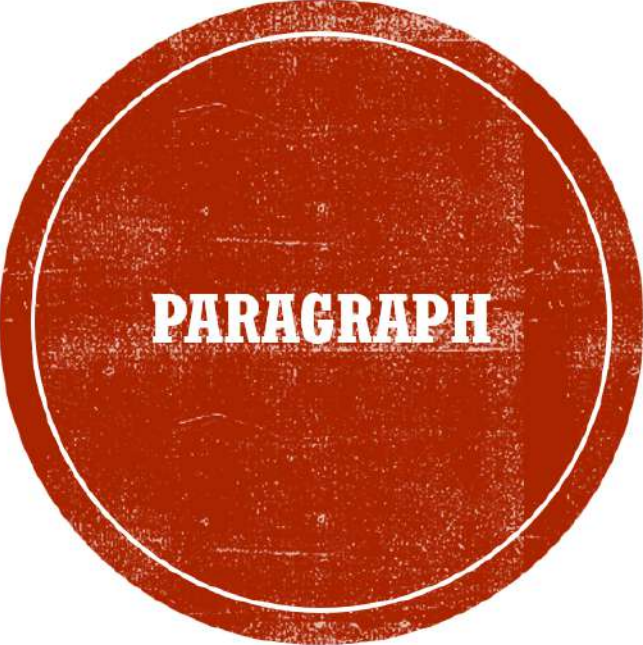




PARAGRAPH

- A paragraph is a group of related sentences that discuss **one** (and usually only one) **main idea**.
- The number of sentences in a paragraph is unimportant; however, a paragraph should **not** be **too long** (boring & misleading) **or too short** (insufficient or unconvincing).
- Thus, a paragraph should be **long enough** to support the topic and be **convincing**.

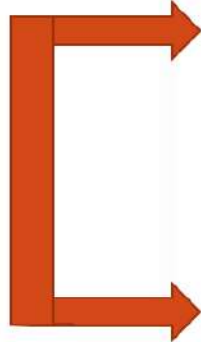
Sandwich Organizer

Use this form as you write paragraphs to help you organize your ideas.

Topic sentence
(TS)



Supporting Sentences:
Major (MA) and
Minor (MI) Details



Concluding sentence
(CS)



Topic:

Detail:

Detail:

Detail:

Conclusion:

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THE TOPIC SENTENCE SHOULD BE

- A complete sentence (Subj.+ verb + adj.)

- How to register for college classes

X

- Registering for college classes can be a frustrating experience for new students.

✓

INCOMPLETE Communicating with colleagues.

INCOMPLETE How to improve online social networks.



THE TOPIC SENTENCE SHOULD BE

- **the most general sentence in the paragraph**

(since all supporting details are written right after it.)

- *However, the TS should not be too general or too specific.*

- **Examples:**

❑ English has been influenced by other languages.

(too general)

❑ The slang expression so long (meaning “good-bye” is probably a corruption of the Arabic salaam.

(too specific)

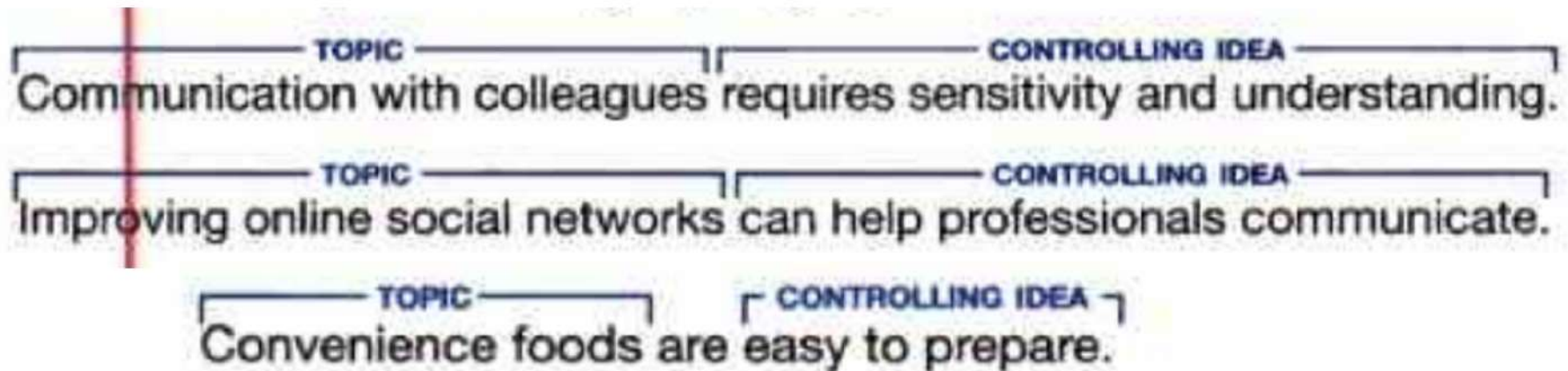
❑ The Arabic origin of many English words is not always obvious.

✓ ✓ ✓



THE TOPIC SENTENCE SHOULD

- Contain both a topic and a controlling idea
- The **topic** names the subject of the paragraph.
- The **controlling idea** limits the topic to a specific area to be discussed.



SUPPORTING SENTENCES

- The supporting sentences are divided into major and minor details.
- **The major details (MA)** support or prove the topic sentence by mentioning facts about the topic.
- **The minor details (MI)** are specific details that support each major idea without adding new facts.

❖ **Examples of (MI):**

examples, additional details, statistics, quotations...



CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)

- **A concluding sentence serves 2 purposes:**
 - It signals the end of a paragraph.
 - It reminds the reader of the important details mentioned.
- **A CS has 2 types:**
 - A restatement of the topic sentence
 - A summary of the main ideas (MA)



CONCLUDING SENTENCE (CS)

N.B. !!

A paragraph does not always need a concluding sentence (**especially body paragraphs in an essay**).

For long single paragraphs, the **CS** is important to help the readers remember the main points.

Never introduce a new idea in the **CS**.



CONCLUDING SIGNALS

- A **CS** is usually introduced using one of the following signals.

END-OF-PARAGRAPH SIGNALS		
Followed by a Comma		Not Followed by a Comma
In brief,	Lastly,	The evidence suggests that . . .
In conclusion,	Therefore,	There can be no doubt that . . .
Indeed,	Thus,	These examples show that . . .
In short,	To sum up,	We can see that . . .
Finally,		





**READ THE FOLLOWING
PARAGRAPH THEN IDENTIFY THE:**

1. TOPIC SENTENCE (**TS**)
2. MAJOR DETAILS (**MA**)
3. MINOR DETAILS (**MI**)
4. CONCLUDING SENTENCE (**CS**)



EXERCISE

Looking back to what life was like two hundred years ago, it is easy to see that some inventions have changed our life to the better, while others have changed it to the worse (). A computer allows us to do so many things that we could not do before (). For example, the computer has become such an important piece of equipment in offices, schools and homes around the world (). On the other hand, the invention of the motor car has brought us more problems than benefits (). For instance, cars have caused terrible air pollution (). Moreover, the additional problems of traffic jams and road accidents have actually made our lives worse, not better (). To sum up, there have been several inventions over the last two centuries that have brought us huge benefits as opposed to other inventions that have brought us serious problems ().



EXERCISE

Television can have negative effects on people for many reasons (). First, many viewers are children who have not formed a strong understanding of right and wrong (). If a person on TV gets what he or she wants by stealing it, a child may copy this behavior (). Second, many heroes in today's programs achieve their goals by violent means (). Unfortunately, many TV viewers take movie stars as their idols and imitate what they do and viewers might use similar violent means to achieve their objectives (). Finally, many TV programs discuss crimes (). Thus, criminals can get ideas on how to commit these crimes from watching TV (). For all these reasons, we can say that watching TV can have negative effects on its viewers ().



Identifying the Topic and Controlling Idea

Read each sentence. Circle the topic and underline the controlling idea.

1. Driving on freeways requires skill and alertness.
2. Driving on freeways requires strong nerves.
3. Driving on freeways sometimes requires an aggressive attitude.
4. The Caribbean island of Trinidad attracts tourists because of its calypso music.
5. Spectacular beaches make Puerto Rico a tourist paradise.
6. Moving away from home can be a stressful experience for young people.
7. Owning an automobile is a necessity for me.
8. It is an expensive luxury to own an automobile in a large city.
9. A major problem for many students is the high cost of tuition and books.
10. Participating in class discussions can be a problem for some students.

PRACTICE



PRACTICE

Read the paragraphs and underline the topic sentences. Then add a good concluding sentence to each paragraph by paraphrasing the topic sentence or summarizing the main points. Remember to use an end-of-paragraph signal.

PARAGRAPH 2

Modern communication technology is raising the stress level for corporate workers. They feel buried under the large number of messages they receive daily. In addition to telephone calls, office workers receive dozens of email, voice mail, and text messages daily. In fact, U.S. managers receive on average more than 200 email messages a day. Because they do not have enough time to respond to these messages during office hours, it is common for them to do so in the evenings or on weekends at home. _____



PRACTICE

Read the paragraphs and underline the topic sentences. Then add a good concluding sentence to each paragraph by paraphrasing the topic sentence or summarizing the main points. Remember to use an end-of-paragraph signal.

PARAGRAPH 1

A person can be a good communicator by being a good listener. When speaking with someone, a good listener pays close attention to the speaker's words while looking at his or her face. A good listener also shows interest by smiling and nodding. Also, posture is important; it can affect communication for both the speaker and the listener. For instance, sitting slumped in a chair makes a person seem passive, while a relaxed posture with the body bent slightly forward shows interest in the speaker and the conversation. Remember, too, that good communicators do not interrupt while someone is speaking; although interruption is active participation, it can be impolite. _____



PARAGRAPH 2

A Hawaiian Legend

Native people create legends to explain unusual phenomena in their environment. A legend from the Hawaiian island of Kauai explains how the naupaka flower, a flower that grows on beaches there, got its unusual shape. The flower looks like half a small daisy—there are petals on one side only. The legend says that the marriage of two young lovers on the island was opposed by both sets of parents. The parents found the couple together on a beach one day, and to prevent them from being together, one of the families moved to the mountains, separating the young couple forever. As a result, the naupaka flower separated itself into two halves. One half moved to the mountains, and the other half stayed near the beach. This story is a good example of a legend invented by native people to interpret the world around them.

PRACTICE

- **Read the paragraphs. Decide whether each concluding sentence summarizes the main points or repeats the topic sentence in different words. Then answer the questions.**
- **What are the conclusion signal in each paragraph? Circle them.**

